

ICU Team Update

September 2026

Your monthly briefing from the senior team

■ RESEARCH CORNER

SHORTER Trial - national recognition

2nd highest recruiting site in the country - 8 patients recruited since May.

New: ICU Research Hub

All active trials now have one home online, with a quick eligibility screening tool. swb-icu.github.io/research

■ CLINICAL UPDATES

Pupillometer SOP now live on SPARC

Use for acquired brain injury categories only - not general neuro assessment (use a pen torch).

Russell PneumoFix

Preferred device for tension pneumothorax decompression - stocked on the emergency trolley.

Extubation checklist reminder

Laminated checklists in every zone, plus a Unity form from the medical team before extubation.

Did you know? CVC and cannula care

No routine fixed-day changes - remove when no longer needed or if infection is suspected.

■ SAFETY AND QUALITY

Escalate early, out of hours

Low threshold for senior discussion when priorities or patients change quickly.

Gentamicin - stop and check

Before every dose: still needed? Renal function? Level required?

Discharge checklist and TEP audit

Checklist within 1 hour of ward transfer; TEP forms fully completed and signed same day.

NMP update

Janine Lonsdale is the new NMP lead - prescribing self-audit rolling out soon.

■ TEAM NEWS

Farewell Amber

20 years on ICU at SWBH, retiring this September - last day Monday 7th. Collection and get-together via Becky O'Dwyer.

Welcome our new psychologist

Antonius Kornelis Martinus van der Sluijs joins us from John Radcliffe within the next 3-4 months.

Rachel elected to national group

Rachel Allen joins the Intensive Care Society Pharmacy Professional Advisory Group.

Congratulations Suffiya

Completed the Bradford University Critical Care Pharmacy Technician Course.

New arrival

Congratulations to Jodie and Rhys Parry on baby Elowyn Rose.

■ TRAINING

Keep bedspace vents clear

Blocked vents reduce air flow and air change quality.

Contact lenses on admission

Check and document on admission - remove promptly to avoid eye complications.

PPE - check infectious status

FFP3 for respiratory symptoms until infection is confirmed or excluded.

APRV resources survey

Two minutes, anonymous - link in the full newsletter.

Face fit testing

Check yours is in date and you know your mask - book via ESR.

■ OPERATIONAL MATTERS

No EEG on Saturdays

Sunday only, on-call from home - please give early notice for workload planning.

ICUsteps

Patient and family support charity - QR codes at the bedside on admission.

Newsletter submissions

Please use the submission form, not email or WhatsApp.